

Amended Internship Regulations for the degree programmes in Mechanical Engineering, Sustainable Engineering, Electrical Engineering and Information Technology, Mechatronics, Mechatronics and Robotics, Production and Logistics, Optical Technologies, Nanotechnology, Energy Technology, Biomedical Engineering, Medical Engineering, and Industrial Engineering and Management, leading to the degrees of Bachelor of Science and Master of Science, at Gottfried Wilhelm Leibniz Universität Hannover of 12 December 2013, as amended on 9 April 2021

The Faculty of Mechanical Engineering, the Faculty of Electrical Engineering and Computer Science, the Faculty of Mathematics and Physics, the Faculty of Natural Sciences, and the Faculty of Economics and Management of Gottfried Wilhelm Leibniz Universität Hannover have issued the following Joint Internship Regulations pursuant to § 44 (1) of the Lower Saxony Higher Education Act.

Overview:

§ 1 Scope.....	2
§ 2 Responsibilities of the Internship Office.....	2
§ 3 Purpose of the Internship.....	2
§ 4 Total Duration of the Internship	2
§ 5 Pre-Study Internship.....	3
§ 5.1 Fields of Activity.....	3
§ 5.2 Recognition and Scheduling of the Pre-Study Internship.....	3
§ 6 Specialised Internship	3
§ 6.1 Fields of Activity.....	3
§ 6.2 Recognition and Scheduling of the Specialised Internship.....	3
§ 7 Host Companies for the Internship	3
§ 8 Equivalent Periods and Special Provisions	4
§ 8.1 Vocational Training as a Skilled Worker	4
§ 8.2 Professional Employment as an Engineer.....	4
§ 8.3 Employment Before and During Studies (Student Assistant Work).....	4
§ 8.4 Recognised Internships at German Universities.....	4
§ 8.5 Practical Training Activities in School-Based Education	4
§ 8.6 Technical Training and Military Service in the Bundeswehr.....	5
§ 8.7 Technical Training in the Federal Volunteer Service or Voluntary Year.....	5
§ 8.8 Further Provisions on Equivalent Periods	5
§ 9 Reporting on Internship Activities.....	5
§ 9.1 Pre-Study Internship	5
§ 9.2 Specialised Internship.....	5
§ 10 Certificate.....	6
§ 11 Internship Abroad.....	6
§ 12 Recognition Procedure.....	6
§ 13 Special Provisions.....	6
§ 14 Deception	6
§ 15 Entry into Force and Transitional Provision.....	6
Table A1: Experience and Activity Areas in the Pre-Study Internship	

§ 1 Scope

These Internship Regulations, based on the Examination Regulations and the Admission Regulations of the degree programmes concerned, govern the procedure for the implementation and recognition of professional practical activities. For the purposes of these Regulations, the entirety of such professional practical activities shall hereinafter be referred to as "the internship".

§ 2 Responsibilities of the Internship Office

- 1) The recognition of internships completed within the degree programmes in Mechanical Engineering, Sustainable Engineering, Electrical Engineering and Information Technology, Mechatronics, Mechatronics and Robotics, Production and Logistics, Optical Technologies, Nanotechnology, Energy Technology, Biomedical Engineering, Medical Engineering, and Industrial Engineering and Management shall be carried out by the Joint Internship Office of the Faculty of Mechanical Engineering and the Faculty of Electrical Engineering and Computer Science, in accordance with the procedure set out in these Internship Regulations.
- 2) In addition, the Internship Office provides advice on all questions concerning the planning and implementation of the internship. To avoid later difficulties regarding the recognition of the internship, students are strongly encouraged to consult the Internship Office in advance in cases of doubt.

§ 3 Purpose of the Internship

The primary aim of the pre-study internship is to provide students with initial insights into company structures, workflows, and operational processes. It introduces fundamental industrial manufacturing methods and facilities and thereby conveys essential basic knowledge. The pre-study internship does not require prior knowledge gained in the degree programme and should therefore be completed before the commencement of studies.

The specialised internship serves to enable students to gain experience in typical professional fields and areas of activity relevant to their respective degree programme. It is characterised by the integration of students into a working environment of engineers or other professionals with equivalent qualifications, whose activities are primarily of a developmental, planning, or supervisory nature. Students should, through close contact, become familiar with the typical tasks and working methods of practising engineers or equivalent professionals in their respective disciplines and, under supervision, be able to carry out tasks as independently as possible.

In addition, internships are intended to provide insights into organisational structures within companies and into the social dimensions of the working environment.

§ 4 Total Duration of the Internship

- 1) The total duration of the required internships is determined by the applicable Examination Regulations or Admission Regulations of the respective degree programme.
- 2) One internship week corresponds, in the case of full-time employment, to the regular weekly working hours of the host company. In the case of part-time employment, a total of 40 hours (each of 60 minutes) is counted as one internship week. The same applies to equivalent periods as defined in § 8.
- 3) Public holidays do not need to be made up. Absences due to illness, vacation, bridge days, examination days, or personal reasons must be made up if they exceed 5% of the total internship duration required. Where necessary, an extension of the contract should be requested in order to complete an ongoing internship period in a continuous block.

§ 5 Pre-Study Internship

§ 5.1 Fields of Activity

The pre-study internship is structured into areas of experience and activity, each of which relates to the specific disciplinary background (see Table A1).

§ 5.2 Recognition and Scheduling of the Pre-Study Internship

- 1) For full recognition, the pre-study internship must meet the requirements specified in Table A1.
- 2) Proof of recognition of the pre-study internship by the Internship Office must be submitted to the Examination Office of the relevant faculty within the deadline stipulated in the Examination Regulations or the Admission Regulations of the respective degree programme.
- 3) Since the pre-study internship is expected to be completed prior to the commencement of studies, no credit points (CPs) are awarded for it, and within the standard period of study no dedicated time slots are provided for completing a pre-study internship that has not already been undertaken before enrolment.
- 4) The procedure for recognition is governed by § 12 of these Internship Regulations.

§ 6 Specialised Internship

§ 6.1 Fields of Activity

- 1) These Internship Regulations do not prescribe specific fields of activity for the specialised internship. The professional relevance of an intended field of activity is determined solely by the fulfilment of the objectives of the internship as stated in § 3, as well as by the suitability of the host company in accordance with § 7. Within this framework, students are encouraged to adapt the professional orientation of their specialised internship to their individual academic focus areas and career goals. However, in all cases of doubt concerning the eligibility of an intended, potentially more specialised or less typical internship activity, it is strongly recommended that students consult the Internship Office in advance.

§ 6.2 Recognition and Scheduling of the Specialised Internship

- 1) For full recognition, the specialised internship must fulfil the general characteristics of the fields of activity set out in § 6.1 and the suitability of host companies as defined in § 7.
- 2) Proof of recognition of the internship must be submitted to the Examination Office within the deadline stipulated in the Examination Regulations or the Admission Regulations of the respective degree programme.
- 3) The procedure for recognition is governed by § 12 of these Internship Regulations.

§ 7 Host Companies for the Internship

- 1) The knowledge and experience to be gained in both the pre-study internship and the specialised internship can primarily be acquired in medium-sized or large industrial companies in the fields of mechanical engineering and electrical engineering, but also in other enterprises with a technical or engineering-related focus.
- 2) For the pre-study internship, manufacturing craft enterprises as well as companies in the maintenance and service sector that also carry out industrial-style manufacturing may be suitable, provided that the activities listed in Table A1 can be performed there.
- 3) In addition to their fundamental suitability, companies hosting pre-study internships must also be recognised as training providers by the Chamber of Industry and Commerce or the Chamber of Crafts. Internship activities must be supervised by a person entrusted with training responsibilities.
- 4) Specialised internships may also be carried out in engineering firms and research institutions independent of universities, provided that the intended activities have been coordinated with the In-

ternship Office beforehand.

- 5) In specialised internships, the tasks must be supervised by engineers or other professionals with equivalent qualifications in the relevant field.
- 6) The Internship Office does not provide internship placements. The responsibility for finding suitable internship positions lies solely with the students.
- 7) Students themselves are responsible for compliance with the provisions of these Regulations regarding the suitability of host companies and the implementation of their internship. In every case, a precise clarification of the intended internship arrangements with the host company is required in advance. Students must under no circumstances assume that the mere confirmation of an internship placement by a company automatically ensures that the internship will be carried out in accordance with the requirements set out in these Regulations.

§ 8 Equivalent Periods and Special Provisions

§ 8.1 Vocational Training as a Skilled Worker

Completed, relevant vocational training programmes (apprenticeships) may be recognised as equivalent to up to 100% of the pre-study or specialised internship, provided they meet the requirements of these Regulations to a sufficient degree. The necessary documentation includes relevant certificates and, where applicable, the completed training plan.

§ 8.2 Professional Employment as an Engineer

Relevant professional work experience in an engineering position may be recognised as equivalent to up to 50% of its actual duration. The required documentation consists of employer references or employment certificates, a report prepared in accordance with these Regulations, as well as proof of a university degree.

§ 8.3 Employment Before and During Studies (Student Assistant Work)

Short-term employment carried out before or during studies, which is primarily for earning purposes and for which the company does not explicitly certify the performance of an "internship activity" in its reference, but which is nevertheless suitable within the meaning of these Regulations, may be credited as equivalent periods of up to 100%. The necessary documentation includes employment certificates and reports prepared in line with these Regulations.

§ 8.4 Recognised Internships at German Universities

Internships already recognised at German universities within technical degree programmes will be accepted if they sufficiently meet the requirements of these Regulations. The required documentation includes the relevant certification of recognition from the university and, where applicable, reports as well as employer references.

§ 8.5 Practical Training Activities in School-Based Education

- 1) Practical training periods completed within school-based programmes at vocational grammar schools (with a focus on technology), technical colleges, other equivalent training institutions, or company-based training periods undertaken as part of attendance at a technical secondary school (Fachoberschule Technik) may be recognised as equivalent periods. Up to 50% of the pre-study internship may be substituted by such practical training activities in school-based education, provided they cover the areas of activity required by these Regulations. The necessary documentation includes appropriate school certificates and, where applicable, the training plans of the schools.
- 2) Company internships completed during attendance at general secondary schools will, as a rule, not be recognised.

§ 8.6 Technical Training and Military Service in the Bundeswehr

- 1) Training and service periods completed in maintenance units of the Bundeswehr that meet at least the level of "Material Maintenance Level II" may be recognised as equivalent periods. Up to 50% of the pre-study internship may be replaced in this way, provided that the required areas of activity specified in these Regulations are covered.
- 2) The necessary documentation includes the relevant "General Activity Record" (ATN certificate) or freely formulated references from the military unit, as well as reports prepared in accordance with these Regulations.

§ 8.7 Technical Training in the Federal Volunteer Service or Voluntary Year

Technical training undertaken within the framework of the Federal Volunteer Service (*Bundesfreiwilligendienst*) or a Voluntary Year (*Freiwilliges Jahr*) may be recognised as equivalent periods toward the pre-study internship, insofar as their implementation complies with these Regulations. Recognition requires a certificate from the responsible organisation confirming the training carried out, as well as reports prepared in accordance with these Regulations.

§ 8.8 Further Provisions on Equivalent Periods

Additional provisions concerning equivalent periods can be found in the applicable Examination Regulations or the Admission Regulations of the respective degree programme.

§ 9 Reporting on Internship Activities

- 1) Throughout the entire duration of the internship, students are required to prepare reports, which must be signed with name, date, and company stamp by the person assigned by the host organisation to supervise the internship. These reports must be submitted to the Internship Office when applying for recognition.
- 2) The reports must be written independently by the students themselves. General descriptions without direct reference to the student's own activities, such as copied material from textbooks or other sources, will not be accepted. The reports should follow the style of a technical report, presenting information concisely. The use of external material such as brochures or similar documents should be avoided.
- 3) Students must adapt their reports to the content released by the host organisation. Confidentiality agreements or embargo declarations are not to be signed. Actual results may be omitted or replaced with comparable examples. However, even while complying with confidentiality requirements, the task itself (including starting point, methodology, objectives, etc.) must remain clearly recognisable and comprehensible, and the report must not be shortened in length as a result.

§ 9.1 Pre-Study Internship

During the pre-study internship, a weekly work report must be prepared, describing the activities carried out and the work results achieved. Each report must be at least one DIN A4 page in length. Illustrations in the form of sketches or workshop drawings created by the student may be included to aid clarity but do not reduce the required length of the written text. Every weekly report must be signed by the supervisor(s) at the host company.

§ 9.2 Specialised Internship

During the specialised internship, a continuous report (in prose) of two pages per recognised internship week must be written over the entire internship period. Images, diagrams, and tables may be incorporated into the report to illustrate complex issues. No weekly reports are required. The report should include a description of the tasks assigned, methodologies, approaches to solutions, findings, and personal experiences within the professional environment. It must also contain an introductory section describing the company and its activities, as well as a concluding evaluation. An overall table of con-

tents must also be included. The report must be signed and officially stamped by the supervisor at the host company.

§ 10 Certificate

- 1) In order to apply for recognition of an internship, in addition to the reports, a certificate from the host company confirming completion of the internship must be submitted.
- 2) The certificate must include the following details:
 - a) Company, department (if applicable), location, sector
 - b) Surname, first name, date and place of birth of the intern
 - c) Start and end dates of the internship
 - d) Breakdown of activities by field or type of activity and their duration
 - e) Explicit statement of the number of days of absence in accordance with these Regulations, even if no absences occurred

§ 11 Internship Abroad

- 1) Internship activities may be undertaken partially or entirely abroad; this is explicitly permitted and strongly encouraged. Such activities, however, must comply in all respects with the requirements set out in these Regulations.
- 2) For an internship abroad, the certificate and the report may also be written in English. If the certificate is not written in German or English, a certified translation must be attached.

§ 12 Recognition Procedure

To apply for recognition, students must submit an internship recognition form, the company certificate, and the documentation listed in § 8. The Internship Office verifies compliance with the requirements set out in these Regulations. Following review, the Internship Office confirms recognition or, in cases of doubt, invites the student for further consultation.

§ 13 Special Provisions

Students with physical or mental impairments or those severely restricted by illness may agree on special arrangements with the Internship Office, provided they can demonstrate that it is not possible for them to complete the internship as prescribed.

§ 14 Deception

When applying for recognition of an internship, students must declare in lieu of an oath that they have completed the internship in the form described and have prepared the report independently. Any attempt at deception may result in de-registration (exmatriculation). Where appropriate, Leibniz Universität Hannover may use electronic comparison tools to detect irregularities in examination procedures.

§ 15 Entry into Force and Transitional Provision

- 1) This amendment to the Internship Regulations of 12 December 2013, as last amended, shall enter into force on 1 October 2025 following its approval by the Presidential Board and its publication in the Official Gazette of Gottfried Wilhelm Leibniz Universität Hannover.
- 2) Students enrolled in the above-mentioned degree programmes at Gottfried Wilhelm Leibniz Universität Hannover shall be subject to the provisions of these Internship Regulations from the date of entry into force.
- 3) Internship periods and fields of activity that were recognised before the entry into force of these amended Internship Regulations shall continue to be taken into account or accepted.

A1: Experience and Areas of Activity in the Pre-Study Internship	
At least 50% of the internship must be completed in the activity areas VP 1 or VP 2.	
At least two VP areas of activity to be chosen.	
VP 1 Manual tasks in industrial metal and plastic processing.	Machining Manufacturing Processes Examples: sawing, filing, drilling, thread-cutting, turning, planing, milling, grinding Forming Manufacturing Processes Examples: cold forming, bending, straightening, pressing, rolling, drawing, cutting, punching, riveting, forging Shaping Manufacturing Processes Examples: casting, sintering, plastic injection moulding Joining and Separation Processes Examples: soldering, welding, adhesive bonding, flame cutting
VP 2 Manual electrotechnical and electronic tasks.	Examples: Manufacture of components, assemblies, devices, and systems in electrical engineering and electronics; assembly, semiconductor fabrication, maintenance and repair of electrotechnical and electronic apparatus, devices, systems, control cabinet construction, and electrical installation.
VP 3 Industrial manufacturing with machines and production equipment.	Examples: CNC machines, forming presses, lasers.
VP 4 Operation of facilities/equipment.	Examples: assembly, commissioning, maintenance, servicing, and repair of machines and equipment in industrial or medical environments.
VP 5 Participation in operational processes within the production environment.	Examples: logistics (incoming and outgoing goods inspection, inventory monitoring), assembly, robotics, peripherals (component cleaning, lubrication, deburring), measurement technology (industrial or medical).